

FROM MEMORIES TO HISTORY



William James Gilroy

A Life in Five Acts



Featuring

In the Shadow Of Dorset Street

Soldiering and Reinvention

The Ina Mathieson Years

The Lost Years

Annie Mitchell and the Final Years



RESEARCHED AND PRODUCED BY JOHN WHITELAW GILROY

2026





We first met William James Gilroy briefly in *From Memories to History*, where he appeared mainly as a figure from childhood memory — a grandfather living by the sea at Margate, reached after exciting train journeys from Edinburgh, and accompanied in memory by an enormously overweight golden retriever named Bonnie.

Behind those small recollections, however, lay a remarkable and often difficult life. William's story began in the poverty of Victorian Bethnal Green and unfolded through industrial schools, military service, wartime injury, family tragedy and constant reinvention. This biography attempts to move beyond fleeting family memory to reconstruct the fuller story behind the man.



Dramatis Personae

AND ORDER OF SCENES

The Cast

William James Gilroy

himself

His parents

William James Gilroy

Rosetta Amelia Harris

His First Wife and Children

Caroline Mathieson Whitelaw

William James Gilroy

John Gilroy

Caroline Mathieson Gilroy

Rosetta Hannah Gilroy

Alexander Blacklaw Gilroy

Catherine Blacklaw Gilroy

His Second Wife

Annie Mitchell



The Programme

Act I - In the Shadow Of Dorset Street

Scene 1 - Birth and East End Poverty

Scene 2 - A Different Road

Act II - Soldiering and Reinvention

Scene 1 - A Boy Becomes a Soldier

Scene 2 - Disgrace and Second Chances

Scene 3 - Marriage and War

Scene 4 - To France

Scene 5 - The Cost of War

Act III - The Ina Mathieson Years

Scene 1 - Picking Up the Pieces

Scene 2 - Building a Home

Scene 3 - Cracks in the Picture

Act IV - The Lost Years

Scene 1 - After Ina

Act V - Annie Mitchell and the Final Years

Scene 1 - Starting Again

Scene 2 - Circle

ACT I

In the Shadow of Dorset Street

SCENE 1

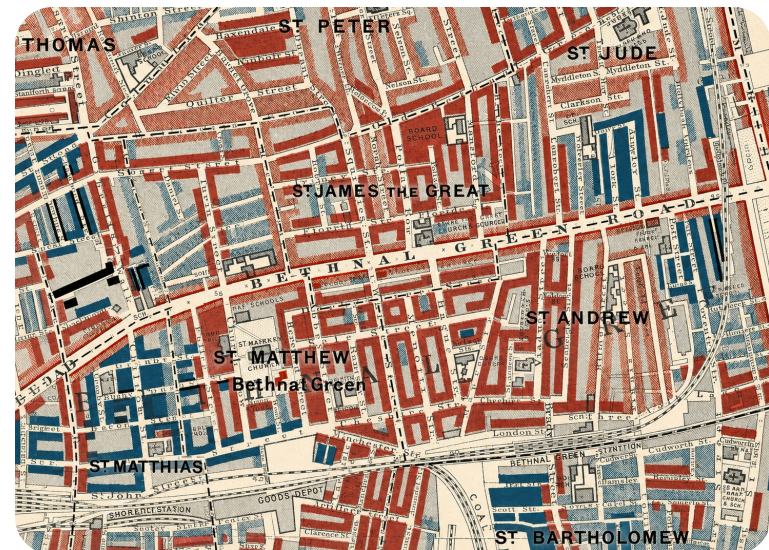
Birth and East End Poverty

William James Gilroy entered the world on Thursday 14 May 1891 at 14 Margaret Place in Bethnal Green, East London, the only known son of William James Gilroy of Edinburgh, a labourer, and Rosetta Amelia Harris of Spitalfields, a hawker. A month later, on 16 June, he was baptised at St James the Great in Bethnal Green. On paper these details appear straightforward enough, but William's beginnings were perhaps rather more complicated than the records first suggest. Evidence later in the family's story raises doubts about whether his parents had legally married at all. Whatever the circumstances, William's first years would be spent among some of the poorest streets in Victorian London.

During the late nineteenth century, concern about poverty in Britain's growing cities was beginning to trouble politicians and social reformers. London had expanded at an astonishing pace, drawing workers from across Britain and beyond, but prosperity was

far from evenly shared. To understand conditions in the capital, the businessman and reformer Charles Booth undertook his vast Inquiry into the Life and

Poverty Map Portion for Bethnal Green



Labour of the People in London. Booth's investigators walked street by street through the city,

recording observations and producing colour-coded maps showing relative wealth and deprivation.

Margaret Place, where William had been born, fell into Booth's darkest category: black. His accompanying police notebooks described the residents as the "lowest class" and characterised the street as one of broken windows, open doors, dirt and ragged children. It was an unforgiving environment in which to begin life. Yet, to the thousands who lived there, these conditions were not exceptional; they were simply normal life in the East End.

Little survives to tell us directly about William's earliest childhood. School records suggest frequent movement. By 1899 the family were living at 12 Jane Street near the London Docks, where William's father was employed as a dock labourer. Booth's notes judged this district more favourably than Margaret Place, describing it as mixed in character: some comfortable, some poor. It represented no dramatic rise in fortune, but perhaps a small step away from the harshest conditions of Bethnal Green.

Two years later, on the night of the 1901 census, William was living with his parents at 34 Dorset

Street in Spitalfields. Four families occupied the address, with sixteen people crowded into the building. Labourers predominated, together with small-scale occupations that offered little security. William's mother Rose worked independently as a hawker while his father earned his living through labouring work. By the turn of the century, Dorset Street had gained a grim reputation as perhaps the most notorious street in London, remembered as the location of the final Jack the Ripper murder and widely associated with poverty, overcrowding and crime. A campaigning journalist, Fred McKenzie of the Daily Mail, filed a report about the conditions in the street which was published on 16th July 1901. The article, reproduced overleaf, gives a very lucid description of the problems facing the populace living in Dorset Street at the time.

For many children such surroundings were not merely a backdrop to life but something that actively shaped their futures.



Daily Mail

Transcript of Fred McKenzie's 1901 Article

“[it] has recently sprung into undesired notoriety. Here we have a place which boasts of an attempt at murder on an average once a month, of a murder in every house, and one house at least, a murder in every room. Policemen go down it as rule in pairs. Hunger walks prowling in its alleyways, and the criminals of to-morrow are being bred there to-day.

The lodging-houses of Dorset Street and of the district around are the head centres of the shifting criminal population of London. Of course, the aristocrats of crime - the forger, the counterfeiter, and the like do not come here. In Dorset Street we find more largely the common thief, the pickpocket, the area meak, the man who robs with violence, and the unconvicted murderer. The police have a theory, it seems, that it is better to let these people congregate together in one mass where they can be easily be found than to scatter them abroad. And Dorset Street certainly serves the purpose of a police trap.

If this were all, something might be said in favour of allowing such a place to continue. But it is not all. No criminal centre is wholly criminal, and to represent even the lodging

houses of Dorset Street as wholly inhabited by the utterly depraved would be wrong. There are many men in them who are simply "down on their luck." There are many boys there whose sole desire is to lead a free life, and who have not yet known the policeman's clutch on their shoulder.

Dorset Street circa 1902



There are even a few women, though but a very few, who have not yet shared in the almost inevitable rain which comes on their sex in such a place.

Here comes the real and greatest harm that Dorset Street does. Respectable people, whose main offence is their poverty, are thrown in close and constant contact with

the agents of crime. They become familiarized with law-breaking. They see the best points of the criminals around them. If they are in want, as they usually are, it often enough a thief who shares his spoils with them to give them bread. And there are those who are always ready to instruct these new-comers in the simple ways of making a dishonest living. Boy thieves are trained as regularly and systematically around Dorset Street to-day as they were in the days of *Oliver Twist*”

A Different Road

After the 1901 census, William was attending St Anne's Roman Catholic School. Admission records show that he transferred there from St Jude's on 27 January 1902, recording his birth date as 14 May 1891, naming his father as William James Gilroy, and giving the family address as 27 Wilkes Court, Great Pearl Street. Less than three months later, on 24 April 1902, William was withdrawn from the school. Beyond these sparse entries, the records remain silent, but they suggest a childhood marked by movement and uncertainty rather than stability.

A few months later another official record provides a far more troubling glimpse into William's life. A City of London Union workhouse register records that eleven-year-old William had been arrested by Police Constable 989 and charged with begging before being taken to the workhouse. The following day he was removed by another officer. The record itself tells us almost nothing of the circumstances surrounding the event. It offers no explanation of where William had been living, whether he was alone, or what had led him there. Yet the entry hints at a childhood very different from that experienced by most children today.

Late Victorian and Edwardian authorities increasingly viewed children living on the streets as both vulnerable and potentially dangerous — children in need of rescue, discipline, and supervision. One of the solutions developed during this period was the industrial school system. These institutions were intended for children considered neglected, homeless, beyond parental control, or at risk of drifting into crime. Although sometimes compared with reform schools, they were often places where poverty and hardship rather than criminality brought children through the doors.

William's later army records suggest that he was subsequently attending the East London Industrial School at Brookbank Road in Lewisham. The evidence points strongly toward his arrest for begging being the event that led him there. His military attestation papers later noted that he had been away from his parents' home for more than four years and also referred to the begging offence. Whether William entered the school because he had been living rough, was deemed beyond parental control, or fell into one of the other categories used by the courts remains uncertain.

Paradoxically, the institution that removed William from the streets may also have given him one of the few lasting threads running through the rest of his life. On his military attestation form he later described his occupation simply as "musician". Many industrial schools maintained military-style bands, and surviving photographs and competition records

East London Industrial School Band circa 1909



suggest that the East London Industrial School did the same. Music appears repeatedly throughout William's life: first in the school environment, later during his military service, and eventually in his work as a piano tuner. Amid the instability of his childhood, music may have become one of the few constants.





ACT II

Soldiering and Reinvention

SCENE 1

A Boy Becomes a Soldier

On 13 November 1906, at only fifteen years of age, William James Gilroy joined the 6th (Inniskilling) Dragoons. For a boy whose childhood had been shaped by poverty, instability and time spent in an industrial school, the army may have offered something that had been largely absent from his life — structure, purpose and regular pay. On enlistment he named his next of kin as William James and Rose Gilroy of 1 Church Road, Bethnal Green, suggesting that despite the years spent away from home, some connection with his parents remained.

The physical description recorded in William's enlistment papers gives a vivid reminder of just how young he really was. He stood only four feet ten inches tall and weighed ninety-three pounds. Six months later, following military

training and gymnastics, he had grown four inches and gained over twenty pounds in weight. The army was not merely changing his occupation; it was still helping to shape the growing boy himself.

*Inniskilling Dragoons Cap
Badge 1900*



William's service with the Dragoons carried him much farther than the streets of East London ever had. Following training in Ireland, he served in Egypt and later in India. For someone who had grown up among the crowded streets of Bethnal Green and Spitalfields, these postings must have opened an entirely different world. The East End had given way to

military camps, troop ships and distant countries across the Empire.

The Inniskilling Dragoons themselves carried a proud history. Raised in Ireland in 1689, the regiment had fought at the Boyne, Waterloo and in the Crimea. William had joined a regiment steeped in tradition and ceremony, part of a cavalry arm whose image still reflected the fading grandeur of the nineteenth-century army. Photographs from the period show mounted soldiers in full dress uniform, an appearance far removed from the grim realities that modern warfare would soon bring.

Yet William's first military career ended abruptly. In March 1910 he was tried by District Court Martial after being convicted of uttering forged documents and conduct considered detrimental to military discipline. The punishment was severe: discharge with ignominy and a sentence of hard labour. Just as the army had seemed to offer William a path away from his difficult beginnings, that opportunity now appeared to have collapsed entirely.



A Tale of Two Inniskillings

William James Gilroy served with the 6th (Inniskilling) Dragoons at the same time as Captain Lawrence Edward Grace Oates, later immortalised as one of the heroes of Terra Nova Expedition. Both men served in the



same cavalry regiment and experienced postings in Ireland, Egypt and India, yet their lives could hardly have begun more differently.

Oates was the son of a wealthy landowning family, educated at Eton and commissioned as an officer before achieving lasting fame through exploration and self-sacrifice in Antarctica. William, by contrast, was born into the poverty of London's East End, spent time in an industrial school, and enlisted as a teenage trooper. Their paths briefly overlapped within the same regiment, but one would become a celebrated national hero while the other fought a quieter struggle through war, injury, family hardship and constant reinvention.

Disgrace and Second Chances

One of the more intriguing mysteries in William's story is not how he entered the army, but how he managed to return after leaving it under such circumstances. Less than a year after his ignominious discharge, records suggest that William had once again found his way into military life. Precisely how this occurred remains uncertain. One possibility lies within the offence itself — the reference to forged documents may indicate irregularities of identity or paperwork rather than serious criminal intent — but the surviving evidence is frustratingly incomplete.

By May 1914 William's life appeared to have regained a measure of stability. The London Gazette recorded his appointment as a postman in Sheffield, respectable employment that perhaps suggested a fresh beginning. Yet Europe was moving steadily toward war, and William's connection with the military had not ended. Later records indicate that as a reservist he was recalled to active service during the summer of 1914.

The London Gazette

First published in 1665, The London Gazette is the official journal of the British Government and one of the oldest continuously

published newspapers in the United Kingdom. Unlike ordinary newspapers, it records official notices of state, including military commissions and promotions, civil service appointments, honours and awards, bankruptcies, company notices, and legal announcements. For many public servants and members of the armed forces, appearing in The London Gazette represented formal public recognition of an appointment, promotion, or achievement. William James Gilroy's appointment as a postman was therefore not merely a local employment matter but an official government appointment recorded in the nation's public record.



Marriage and War

By the summer of 1914 William's life appeared to be moving in a more settled direction. He had secured work as a postman and had returned to military service through the reserves. Yet events unfolding across Europe would quickly sweep away any sense of stability. Following the assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand in June, alliances between the major European powers began to unravel. Within weeks Britain found itself at war with Germany.

Amid these dramatic events William's own life was also changing rapidly. On 21 October 1914, at the age of twenty-three, he married Ina Mathieson Whitelaw in Edinburgh. William was serving as a bombardier with the Royal Field Artillery and was based at Piershill Barracks to the east of the city. Ina, also twenty-three, was working as a domestic servant and living in Edinburgh. Their marriage took place by declaration in the presence of two witnesses rather than through the traditional reading of banns in church.

RFA Brigade on parade at Piershill Barracks in 1916



The speed of events raises interesting questions. Only months earlier William had been employed as a postman and living elsewhere. Now he had returned to military service and had married Ina in Scotland. Their courtship can only have taken place within a remarkably short period of time. The surviving records tell us nothing of how they met, but they leave many unanswered questions about those first months together.

Their early married life was likely brief. The Royal Field Artillery was expanding rapidly for wartime service and preparations were already underway to send men overseas.

Like countless newly married couples of the period, William and Ina may have had little time to establish a home before military duty intervened once again.

As Europe descended into conflict, William was preparing to leave Britain.

To France

By July 1915 William was serving with D Battery of the 125th Brigade of the Royal Field Artillery, part of the Army's 37th Division. Before crossing to France the brigade had spent time at Tidworth in Wiltshire preparing for service overseas. Training camps were crowded places where men and horses, guns and wagons were assembled into a military machine destined for the Western Front.

Unlike the cavalry service William had known with the Dragoons, artillery work revolved around teamwork and relentless routine. The brigade was equipped with eighteen-pounder field guns, among the most important weapons in the British Army. These guns provided mobile fire support close behind the front line and would become one of the principal tools of modern warfare.

When William's unit arrived in France, they were sent to relieve French forces near Fonquevillers and entered action on 5 September 1915. The scale of

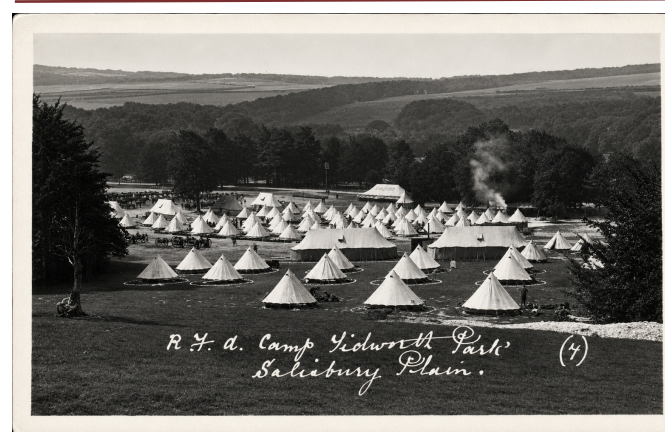
the operation was immense. The brigade strength included more than seven hundred men and hundreds of horses, together with guns, limbers and ammunition wagons. Behind every gun firing on the battlefield lay an enormous system of men, animals and equipment working together.

For William, whose childhood had begun in the crowded streets of East London, life had now carried him to another world entirely. Yet the realities of the Western Front were unlike anything he had previously encountered. Endless mud, shellfire and exhaustion would become part of daily life.

The romantic image of soldiering that had once accompanied cavalry uniforms and distant postings was rapidly disappearing.

War had become something much harsher.

RFA Camp Tidworth circa 1915



The Cost of War

The surviving records of William's wartime service contain only brief entries, yet even a few lines can reveal the course of a life altered forever. On 7 February 1916, while serving near Fonquevillers, an entry in the brigade war diary recorded that Acting Bombardier William James Gilroy had been wounded in an accident, "the cause of which has not yet been discovered." The record itself offered no further explanation.

The consequences, however, were severe. Monthly returns from Number 19 Casualty Clearing Station recorded that William's right eye had been removed the following day before he was transferred to a base hospital. The injury effectively ended his active military career.

The precise circumstances surrounding the accident remain unknown. It may have involved ammunition, artillery equipment, or one of the many hazards that accompanied life behind and at

the front line. The Western Front was dangerous not only because of enemy action. Accidents involving guns, horses, vehicles and munitions were a constant risk, and soldiers could be injured or killed far from the battlefield itself.

For William the consequences would be permanent. He eventually left the army on 28 December 1917 as no longer fit for active service. His wartime service was recognised with the award of the Silver War Badge, the British War Medal and the Victory Medal. These decorations marked his contribution to the war effort, but they could not restore what had been lost.

For a second time in his life William found himself standing at an uncertain crossroads. As a child he had left the streets of the East End for the discipline of the industrial school. Now, after war and injury, he again faced the challenge of beginning anew.

ACT 2 ENDS

RFA 18 Pounder Battery in 1914



ACT III

The Ina Mathieson Years

SCENE 1

Picking Up the Pieces

The war had ended, but for William James Gilroy the return to civilian life cannot have felt like a simple return to normality. He came home carrying more than medals and discharge papers. The loss of an eye had ended his military career, and the effects of his wartime injuries may have followed him long after he left the army behind. Yet life moved quickly onward. William returned to work as a postman and he and Ina were beginning to establish a family together.

In August 1918 their first child, another William James Gilroy, was born in Sheffield. For a brief period there must have been reason for optimism. William had survived the war, he had employment, and he and Ina were beginning married life with a young family of their own. The difficult years of childhood and military service perhaps seemed to be receding into the past.

War's hidden wounds

During and after the First World War many returning soldiers experienced what was then called "shell shock". The condition was poorly understood and often viewed as weakness or indiscipline rather than injury.

But stability proved fragile.

Only a few months later William appeared before Sheffield Police Court charged with theft from the Post Office. Newspaper reports described a respected former serviceman whose life had begun to unravel. The case itself paints a striking and rather tragic picture. William had spoken repeatedly of believing that "traps" were being set for him and was said to suffer violent moods and disturbing behaviour which his defence argued were linked to wartime injuries.

The court imposed a sentence of three months imprisonment. The offence itself was serious, but the reports leave an impression of a man struggling with burdens that few at the time properly understood. Today there might be discussion of

trauma or psychological injury arising from military service. In 1919 such concepts scarcely existed. Men were expected simply to return to ordinary life and carry on.

For William, rebuilding his life would once again become necessary.



FOSTERS' SALE
BARGAINS IN EVERY DEPARTMENT.
10-16, HIGH STREET.
SHARROW, WAINMATE AND VICTORIA.
AN IMPERIAL BUILDING, SHEFFIELD.

YORKSHIRE Telegraph & Star



"STILL THE BEST AND STILL THE BRIGHTEST."
BASS MILD ALE
(from last)
OFTEN IMITATED,
NEVER EQUALLED.
12/- per Dozen Large Bottles.
Of Licensed Dealers.
SHEFFIELD BOTTLERS
WHEATLEY and BATES, LTD.,
SHEFFIELD.

No. 10,086.

SHEFFIELD, FRIDAY EVENING, JANUARY 31, 1919.

REGISTERED AT THE G.P.O.
AS A NEWSPAPER.

ONE PENNY.

POSTMAN'S THEFT.

Sheffield Ex-Soldier's Good Record Spoilt.

Wearing a Discharged Service Badge, William James Gilroy (27), of 40, Wood Road, Hillsboro, appeared before Mr. W. S. Skelton and Mr. T. G. Evans at the Sheffield Police Court, to-day, to answer the serious charge of stealing one £1 Treasury note, two 10s. Treasury notes, and 4s. 7½d. in money, the property of the Postmaster-General.

Mr. Geoffrey Chambers, who prosecuted on behalf of the postal authorities, said the prisoner was a reservist and was called up for service in July 1914. In 1916 his right eye was destroyed by shrapnel, and he was finally discharged in 1917. He was employed as a postman previous to the war, and after discharge he returned in the same capacity. At the time of his arrest his income—including pension—was £5 10s. per week.

During the past six months, said Mr. Chambers, numerous complaints had been received by the Sheffield Post Office of the non-arrival of letters containing currency notes, and suspicion fell upon the defendant. Accordingly, Mr. E. Stratford, of the Secretary's Office, G.P.O. London, came down to Sheffield for the purpose of investigation. On the 23rd January he made up a test letter containing a £1 Treasury note, two 10s. notes, and 4s. 7½d. in money, and all were marked in a certain way. Next morning, the 24th inst., Mr. Stratford, accompanied by a detective, proceeded to Clubgarden Road, Sharro, and posted the letter to a fictitious address at Dunford Bridge. Prisoner was seen to clear the letter-box, and on his arrival at the head office, his bag was searched but the letter was missing. On being questioned by Mr. Stratford he said, "I took the letter, and have destroyed the envelope." The whole of the money and notes were found on him, and in addition two postal orders for 20s. and 10s., which he admitted stealing a few days previously.

Mr. Edward Stratford gave corroborative evidence, and

Mr. J. R. Swinscoe, who appeared for defendant, said that while they pleaded guilty, there were certain circumstances in the case which the Bench might exercise in the prisoner's favour. For some time past Gilroy had been suffering from delusions, no doubt the result of gunshot wounds in the head. He had repeatedly told his wife that traps were being laid for him by the Post Office, and this seemed to drive him into terrible tempers. When in one of these attacks he did extraordinary things, said Mr. Swinscoe, knocking his head against walls, and becoming very violent. There was little doubt that these attacks were due to injuries received on active service, and he asked the Bench to take a lenient view of the case.

The Chairman said Gilroy would have to go to prison for three months, without hard labour.

POSTMAN'S THEFT

SHEFFIELD EX SOLDIER'S GOOD RECORD SPOILT.

Wearing a Discharged Service Badge, William James Gilroy (27), of 40, Wood Road, Hillsborough, appeared before Mr. W. S. Skelton and Mr. T. G. Evans at the Sheffield Police Court, today, to answer the serious charge of stealing one £1 Treasury note, two 10 shilling Treasury notes, and 4 shillings 7 and a half pence in money, the property of the Postmaster General.

Mr. Geoffrey Chambers, who prosecuted on behalf of the postal authorities, said the prisoner was a reservist and was called for service in July 1914. In 1916 his right eye was destroyed by shrapnel, and he was finally discharged 1917. He was employed as a postman previous to the war, and after discharge he returned in the same capacity. At the time of his arrest his income including pension was £3 16

shillings per week.

During the past six months, said Mr. Chambers numerous complaints had been received by the Sheffield Post Office of the non-arrival of letters containing currency notes, and suspicion fell upon the defendant. Accordingly Mr. E. Stratford, the Secretary's Office, GPO London, came down to Sheffield for the purpose of investigation. On the 23rd January made up test letter containing a £1 Treasury note, two 10 shilling notes, and 4s shillings 7 and a half d in money, and all were marked in certain way. Next morning, the 24th inst., Mr. Stratford, accompanied by a detective, proceeded to Clubgarden Road, Sharro, and posted the letter to a fictitious address at Dunford Bridge. Prisoner was seen to clear the letter-box, and on his arrival at the head office, his bag was searched but the letter was missing. On being questioned by Mr. Stratford he said, "I took the letter, and have destroyed the envelope." The whole of the money and notes were found on

him, and in addition two postal orders for 20 shillings and 10 shillings which he admitted stealing a few days previously.

Mr. Edward Stratford gave corroborative evidence, and Mr. J. R. Swinscoe who appeared for the defendant, said that while they pleaded guilty, there were certain circumstances in the case which the Bench might exercise in the prisoner's favour. For some time past Gilroy had been suffering from delusions, no doubt the result of gunshot wounds in the head. He had repeatedly told his wife that traps were being laid for him by the Post Office, and this seemed drive him into terrible tempers. When in one these attacks he did extraordinary things, said Mr. Swinscoe, knocking his head against walls, and becoming very violent. There was little doubt that these attacks were due to the injuries received on active service, and he asked the Bench to take a lenient view of the case.

The Chairman said Gilroy would have go to prison for three months, without hard labour.

Building a Home

By the early 1920s William and Ina had left Sheffield and returned to Scotland. The reasons are uncertain, but the move perhaps represented another attempt at a fresh start. Records place the family at Penicuik near Edinburgh, where William was employed as a cemetery worker and later in the paper mills. Over the following years the family continued to move as William's occupations changed and opportunities appeared.

The household itself steadily grew. John arrived in 1921, followed by Caroline in 1923 and Rosetta in 1925. Alexander followed in 1928, although his arrival carries one of the small mysteries that occasionally emerge in family history research. Later records consistently give his full date of birth as 12 April 1928 and identify Scotland as his birthplace, yet despite extensive searches no corresponding birth registration has been located in either Scottish or English records. Variations of name, date and location have all been explored without success. Whether the record was missed, incorrectly indexed, or whether some other explanation lies behind its absence remains uncertain. Catherine completed the family in 1930. By then William and Ina had become parents to a

large household whose lives would eventually spread across Britain and beyond.

What is particularly striking is the changing pattern of William's occupations. He appears successively as cemetery worker, papermill worker, musician, insurance collector and piano tuner. At first glance this seems a bewildering assortment of jobs, but viewed another way it may reveal a man willing to adapt repeatedly to changing circumstances.

One thread runs quietly through them all. Music, first encountered during his years in the industrial school and reinforced during military service, seems never entirely to have disappeared from William's life. The boy who had once played in institutional and military bands eventually found work repairing and tuning pianos — perhaps one of the few constants linking childhood and adulthood.

The family itself also continued moving: from Penicuik to Edinburgh and later to Beancross near Polmont. Each move brought new surroundings, new neighbours and new work. Stability was perhaps never complete, but William and Ina nevertheless built a family life amid constant change.

"CHILDREN WILL BE CHILDREN"
Polmont Piano Tuner Who Took Out His Glass Eye.

Sheriff Robertson had some interesting remarks to make on the attitude of adults towards children's pranks in Falkirk Sheriff Court on Wednesday during the hearing of a trial for an alleged breach of the peace.

The accused in the case was a 67-year-old farmer named James Walker, residing at Bean Cross Farm, Polmont, and he pled not guilty to committing a breach of the peace at the door of a neighbour's house on 28th May.

It appeared from the evidence that the whole trouble arose through some boys who were playing with a ball near the accused's farm. The ball bounced into Walker's ground, and when a boy named William James Gilroy attempted to retrieve it, it was alleged that the farmer warned him off. The boy's father took his son's part and the scene which followed resulted in Walker being summoned to Court for creating a disturbance.

A daughter of the accused, in the witness box, said that the boys' ball came into the garden and she saw Gilroy hammering at the dividing fence with an axe or a hammer. She informed her father, who went out and remonstrated with them. Shortly afterwards she heard the boy Gilroy's father shouting out in a loud voice. Witness went outside to see what was the matter, and to tell her father to come inside. She saw Wm. Gilroy, sen., lifting his hand and striking her father on the cheeks. Gilroy then pulled his coat off, took out his glass eye, put down his spectacles, and "started on" her father.

Walker, in his own defence, stated that Gilroy came along after the incident of the ball, and stuck his face close to witness and started shouting at him. He then took his left hand and struck witness on the left cheek. Next he stepped back a pace and came forward again in a fighting attitude. The Fiscal—Did you set your dog on the boy Gilroy?

The Accused—No.

Sheriff Robertson said he had no doubt but that a breach of the peace had been committed, and that both the accused and Gilroy were concerned in it. The whole thing seemed to have arisen through the children playing on the roadway. "I have no doubt that both the accused and myself, and everybody else who has been a boy, and has played with a ball on the roadway, has knocked it into a neighbour's garden and got into trouble. People must keep their tempers and do the best they can under the circumstances. "Children will be children."

A fine of ten shillings was imposed and paid at the Bar.

CHILDREN WILL BE CHILDREN

POLMONT PIANO TUNER WHO TOOK OUT HIS GLASS EYE.

Sheriff Robertson had some interesting remarks to make on the attitude adults towards children's pranks in Falkirk Sheriff Court on Wednesday during the hearing of a trial for an alleged breach of the peace.

The accused in the case was a 67-year-old farmer named James Walker, residing at Bean Cross Farm, Polmont, and pled not guilty to committing a breach of the peace at the door of a neighbour's house on 28th May.

It appeared from the evidence that the whole trouble arose through some boys who were playing with a ball near the accused's farm. The ball bounced into Walker's ground, and when a boy named William James Gilroy attempted to retrieve it, it was alleged that the farmer

warned him off. The boy's father took his son's part and the scene which followed resulted in Walker being summoned to Court for creating a disturbance.

A daughter of the accused, in the witness box, said that the boys' ball came into the garden and she saw Gilroy hammering at the dividing fence with axe or a hammer. She informed her father, who went out and remonstrated with them. Shortly afterwards she heard the boy Gilroy's father shouting out in a loud voice. Witness went outside to see what was the matter, and to tell her father to come inside. She saw Wm. Gilroy, sen., lifting his hand and striking her father on the cheeks. Gilroy then pulled his coat off, took out his glass eye, put down his spectacles, and "started on" her father.

Walker, in his own defence, stated that Gilroy came along after the incident with the ball, and stuck his face close to the witness and started shouting at him. He then took his left hand and struck witness on the

left cheek. Next he stepped back a pace and came forward again in a fighting attitude.

The Fiscal—Did you set your dog on the boy Gilroy?

The Accused—No.

Sheriff Robertson said he had no doubt but that a breach of the peace had been committed, and that both the accused and Gilroy were concerned in it. The whole thing seemed to have arisen through the children playing on the roadway. "I have no doubt that both the accused and myself, and everybody else who has been boy, and has played with a ball on the roadway, has knocked it into a neighbour's garden and got into trouble. People must keep their tempers and do the best they can under the circumstances. "Children will be children."

A fine of ten shillings was imposed and paid at the Bar.

Cracks in the Picture

By the early 1930s the outward picture might have appeared settled. William was working as a piano tuner and the family was established in Scotland. Yet records occasionally allow brief glimpses behind ordinary domestic life.

One such glimpse survives in a newspaper report from 1931. What began as a trivial dispute over boys playing with a football near Bean Cross Farm developed into an extraordinary confrontation. William became involved after his son attempted to retrieve a ball and, according to testimony, tempers quickly escalated. Witnesses later recalled William removing his coat, spectacles and even his glass eye before confronting the farmer. The Sheriff remarked rather philosophically that "children will be children" before imposing a fine.

The story has moments that almost seem comic when viewed from a distance, but it may also hint at something deeper. Earlier records had described episodes of sudden temper and unusual behaviour following William's wartime injuries. Whether this incident reflected lingering effects of those experiences can only be guessed.

Within only a few years the family again moved,

and William had changed occupation once more, returning to work as a mill worker. Questions remain. Why did the move from Beancross occur? Why abandon piano tuning? The records provide answers to some questions but leave others frustratingly unresolved.

Then, in March 1937, the greatest blow of this period arrived. Ina died at Edinburgh Royal Infirmary after a long illness. She was only forty-five years old. William had already survived poverty, institutional life, military disgrace and war, but now he faced a different challenge: the loss of the woman with whom he had built his family.

The next chapter of William's life would begin not with a new opportunity, but with bereavement.



*William's children; William, Caroline and John Gilroy circa 1932.
Picture probably taken at Hamilton Place, Edinburgh*



ACT IV

The Lost Years

SCENE 1

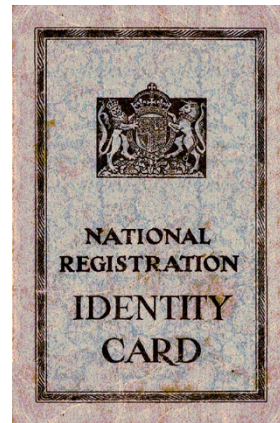
After Ina

Ina's death in March 1937 left William facing one of the most difficult periods of his life. He was now a widower in his mid-forties with several children still dependent upon him. The surviving records tell us remarkably little about what happened in the immediate aftermath, and it is precisely this silence that makes the period so difficult to reconstruct. The family story long held that some of the children had been taken into care following their mother's death, but for many years no documentary evidence could be found to confirm it.

The outbreak of the Second World War finally provides the next clear glimpse into the family's circumstances. On the 1939 Register, compiled as Britain prepared for war and identity cards were issued across the country, Alexander Blacklaw Gilroy appears at Middlemore Homes in Birmingham. The institution had been founded

during the Victorian period to care for poor and orphaned children and had later developed extensive child migration and foster programmes. Alexander's presence there strongly suggests that at least some of William and Ina's children had indeed entered institutional care after their mother's death.

*National Identity Card
1939*



Yet even here the picture remains incomplete. Most of the other entries connected with the home remain closed under modern privacy rules, leaving unanswered questions. Were Alexander's brothers and sisters there too? How had the children travelled from Scotland to England? Did William remain in contact with them? The records offer frustratingly few answers.

The silence itself perhaps tells its own story.

Families disrupted by illness, poverty or bereavement often left scattered and incomplete traces in official records. What survives are isolated snapshots rather than a continuous narrative. For William, whose own childhood had already been shaped by poverty and institutional life, the possibility that some of his children experienced similar disruption carries a certain tragic symmetry.

While much of William's own life during these years remains hidden, the story of his parents can be followed a little further. His father, William James Gilroy senior, died in February 1918 at Islington Infirmary in London. The death certificate described him simply as a general labourer, a modest ending to a life that had begun in Scotland and ultimately brought him to the East End of London. William was living in Sheffield at the time and had recently returned from military service, making it uncertain how much contact father and son had maintained during those years.

His mother Rosetta's story took a different course. In 1915 she married George Winton, a cabinet maker from Shoreditch. Although the marriage

took place when Rosetta was already in her forties, it appears to have provided companionship and stability during later life. Thereafter she appears in the records as Rosetta Winton, the name under which she would remain known for the rest of her life.

The next surviving records reveal William's family only in fragments, scattered through marriage indexes, electoral registers and birth records. His eldest son married in Yorkshire in 1941 while working as a mill worker, suggesting that at least part of the family had remained connected to industrial employment and wartime labour. Meanwhile the wider family was beginning to rebuild itself, one household at a time.

By the mid-1940s another clue to William's own whereabouts emerged in London electoral registers. Between 1945 and 1948 he appears living at 1 Weymouth Place in Shoreditch together with his mother, Rose Winton. After years of uncertainty and movement, William had in some sense returned to the East End streets where his story had first begun.

There is something rather poignant about this

return. As a child William had grown up amid the poverty of Bethnal Green and Spitalfields before escaping through military life and years spent elsewhere in Britain. Now, after war, bereavement and family disruption, he found himself once again living alongside his ageing mother in Shoreditch. The son who had once left the East End behind had eventually come home.

Meanwhile the next generation were beginning to establish families of their own. Rosetta married Leslie Widdowson in London in 1945, while grandchildren soon began to appear in both Scotland and England. The family that had once seemed in danger of fragmentation was slowly spreading outward into new households and new lives.

The surviving records remain uneven and incomplete, but together they suggest a family gradually rebuilding itself after years marked by illness, separation and war. William's own story, which had briefly vanished into the shadows after Ina's death, was beginning to come back into focus.



John's Memories

My own memories of William James Gilroy are fragmentary and viewed very much through the eyes of a small child, yet the journeys to visit him remain vivid.

I was perhaps five or six years old when I first travelled by train from Edinburgh to London. At that age the journey itself felt like a great adventure. Long-distance rail travel still carried a certain excitement and mystery, and for me it was the first journey into a world far beyond home. I remember eagerly anticipating another great novelty — my very first trip on the London Underground.

The reality proved rather disappointing. Much to

My mother, brother David, myself and Annie Mitchell at Cliftonville Avenue



my surprise, the section of the Underground on which we travelled seemed to run entirely above ground. The great subterranean railway I had imagined turned out to look remarkably ordinary.

Bonnie



My later memories are mostly of visits to Margate after William and Annie had moved there. I remember walks along the seafront and the unfamiliar atmosphere of the English seaside, so different from Edinburgh.

Yet more than anything else I remember their dog, Bonnie, an enormously overweight golden retriever who seemed almost as memorable to a small boy as the grandparents themselves.

These memories are slight, but they form my only direct connection with a man whose earlier life had carried him from the slums of Victorian Bethnal Green through war, hardship and constant reinvention long before I ever knew him simply as “Grandad”.



ACT V

Annie Mitchell and the Final Years

SCENE 1

Starting Again

On 8 February 1947 William married Annie Mitchell at St Pancras Register Office in London. He was fifty-five years old. Much of his earlier life had been shaped by instability: poverty in the East End, institutional schooling, military disgrace, wartime injury, imprisonment, bereavement and years of uncertainty following Ina's death. Yet once again William appears to have attempted a fresh beginning.

The marriage record itself contains one of the small touches of personality that occasionally surface in official documents. William described his father's occupation as "Lieutenant Quartermaster", a remarkable promotion for the East End labourer who had actually spent much of his life struggling with poverty and casual employment. Whether this reflected embarrassment, aspiration, reinvention or simple humour is impossible to know, but it suggests

that William continued to reshape parts of his own story even in later life.

*William at St Mark's
Crescent mid 1950's*



Following the marriage William and Annie settled at 16 St Mark's Crescent in Camden, remaining there for roughly a decade. Electoral registers show a household that at times also included Rosetta Widdowson, indicating that family connections continued despite the disruptions of earlier years.

Meanwhile William's children were increasingly establishing families of their own. Marriages in Scotland and England were followed by a steadily growing number of grandchildren. The records of the 1950s become filled less with William's movements and more with births, marriages and the expansion of the wider family. After so many years marked by uncertainty, the later period of William's life appears comparatively settled.

Full Circle

Following the marriage William and Annie settled at 16 St Mark's Crescent in Camden, remaining there for roughly a decade. Electoral registers show a household that at times also included Rosetta Widdowson, indicating that family connections continued despite the disruptions of earlier years.

Meanwhile William's children were increasingly establishing families of their own. Marriages in Scotland and England were followed by a steadily growing number of grandchildren. The records of the 1950s become filled less with William's movements and more with births, marriages and the expansion of the wider family. After so many years marked by uncertainty, the later period of William's life appears comparatively settled.

William James Gilroy died on 6 July 1965 at the Isle of Thanet District Hospital in Margate. His son John registered the death. The certificate described him simply as a retired pianoforte tuner. Behind those few words lay a life that had carried him from the slums of Victorian Bethnal Green through industrial schools, cavalry barracks, the trenches of the First World War, family tragedy and repeated attempts to rebuild himself.

In many ways William's story mirrors the wider journey of Britain itself across the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries: from the poverty of the Victorian East End to the upheavals of industrialisation, war and social change. Yet beneath those larger historical movements remained an individual life marked above all by resilience.

THE END



William with wife, daughter and grandchildren circa 1960, Margate



Ann Widdowson, Rosetta Hannah Gilroy, Annie Mitchel, John Widdowson, William and dog Bonnie

Sources and Credits

Miscellaneous Sources

- 1., National Records of Scotland accessed 10 Nov 2016)
- 2.Poor Law Hospital Record for William J. Gilroy, 16 Jul 1902, London Metropolitan Archives, CBG/346/001, Page:119 (ancestry.co.uk: London, England, Poor Law Hospital Admissions and Discharges, 1842-1918 accessed 10 Mar 2025)
- 3.School Register for Blakesley Street with entry for Wm Jas Gilroy, 1899. London Metropolitan Archives, LCC/EO/DIV05/BLA/AD/001 Description}, Page: 31, Record Number: 1517, (ancestry.co.uk: London, England, School Admissions and Discharges, 1840-1911 accessed 21 JUN 2014)
- 4.School Register for St Anne's RC School with entry for Wm Jas Gilroy, 1899. Tower Hamlets Local History Archives & Library, I/STB/1/1/3, Page:, Record Number: 969, (findmypast.co.uk: National School Admission Registers & Log-Books 1870-1914 accessed 6 Sep 2017)

Census, Registers and Rolls

- 5.1901 England Census Return for 34 Dorset Street. The National Archives of The UK, Class:RG13;Piece:299;Folio:37; Page:28;Schedule:160, (ancestry.co.uk: 1901 England Census, accessed 31 Oct 2019)
- 6.1945 London Electoral Register for 1 Weymouth Place. London Metropolitan Archives, LCC/PER/B/2253; Islington, Page:14, (ancestry.co.uk: London, England, Electoral Registers, 1832-1972, accessed 14 Feb 2016)
- 7.1946 London Electoral Register for 1 Weymouth Place. London Metropolitan Archives, LCC/PER/B/2280; Islington, Page:17, (ancestry.co.uk: London, England, Electoral Registers, 1832-1972, accessed 14 Feb 2016)
- 8.1947 London Electoral Register for 1 Weymouth Place. London Metropolitan Archives, LCC/PER/B/2307; Islington, Page:17, (ancestry.co.uk: London, England, Electoral Registers, 1832-1972, accessed 14 Feb 2016)
- 9.1947 London Electoral Register for 16 St Mark's Crescent. London Metropolitan Archives, LCC/PER/B/2313; Holborn and St Pancras, Page:23, (ancestry.co.uk: London, England, Electoral Registers, 1832-1972, accessed 19 JAN 2015)
- 10.1948 London Electoral Register for 1 Weymouth Place. London Metropolitan Archives, LCC/PER/B/2339; Islington, Page:17, (ancestry.co.uk: London, England, Electoral Registers, 1832-1972, accessed 14 Feb 2016)
- 11.1948 London Electoral Register for 16 St Mark's Crescent. London Metropolitan Archives, LCC/PER/B/2339; Camden, Page:17, (ancestry.co.uk: London, England, Electoral Registers, 1832-1972, accessed 19 JAN 2015)
- 12.1949 London Electoral Register for 16 St Mark's Crescent. London Metropolitan Archives, LCC/PER/B/2366; Camden, Page:, (ancestry.co.uk: London, England, Electoral Registers, 1832-1972, accessed 19 JAN 2015)
- 13.1950 London Electoral Register for 16 St Mark's Crescent. London Metropolitan Archives, LCC/PER/B/2393; Camden, Page:23, (ancestry.co.uk: London, England, Electoral Registers, 1832-1972, accessed 19 JAN 2015)
- 14.1951 London Electoral Register for 16 St Mark's Crescent. London Metropolitan Archives, LCC/PER/B/2412; Camden, Page:23, (ancestry.co.uk: London, England, Electoral Registers, 1832-1972, accessed 19 JAN 2015)
- 15.1952 London Electoral Register for 16 St Mark's Crescent. London Metropolitan Archives, LCC/PER/B/2449; Camden, Page:23, (ancestry.co.uk: London, England, Electoral Registers, 1832-1972, accessed 19 JAN 2015)
- 16.1953 London Electoral Register for 16 St Mark's Crescent. London Metropolitan Archives, LCC/PER/B/2475; Camden, Page:213, (ancestry.co.uk: London, England, Electoral Registers, 1832-1972, accessed 19 JAN 2015)
- 17.1956 London Electoral Register for 16 St Mark's Crescent. London Metropolitan Archives, LCC/PER/B/2577; St Pancras North, Page:22, (ancestry.co.uk: London, England, Electoral Registers, 1832-1972, accessed 19 JAN 2015)

SOURCES AND CREDITS

18. 1957 London Electoral Register for 16 St Mark's Crescent. London Metropolitan Archives, LCC/PER/B/2619; St Pancras North, Page:21, (ancestry.co.uk: London, England, Electoral Registers, 1832-1972, accessed 19 JAN 2015)
19. Scottish Valuation Roll Page containing entry for William J Gilroy, cemetery worker, 1920-1921. National Records of Scotland, GROS: 1920 VR108/48/516, (scotlandspeople.gov.uk: Valuation Rolls accessed 19 JAN 2015)
20. Scottish Valuation Roll Page containing entry for William J Gilroy, millworker, 1935-1936. National Records of Scotland, GROS: VR0108/00063/418, (scotlandspeople.gov.uk: Valuation Rolls accessed 16 Nov 2017)
21. Scottish Valuation Roll Page containing entry for William James Gilroy, insurance collector, 1925-1926. National Records of Scotland, GROS: VR100/498/219, (scotlandspeople.gov.uk: Valuation Rolls accessed 19 JAN 2015)
22. Scottish Valuation Roll Page containing entry for William James Gilroy, piano tuner, 1930-1931. National Records of Scotland, GROS: VR119/74/478, (scotlandspeople.gov.uk: Valuation Rolls accessed 31 Mar 2025)
23. Military and Government Records
24. British Army Medal and Award Record for William J Gilroy, 1914-1920. Western Front Association, WO372, Piece:25910, ancestry.co.uk: UK, British Army World War I Medal Rolls Index Cards, 1914-1920 accessed 17 JUL 2014
25. British Army Medal and Award Record for William James Gilroy, 1914-1915. The National Archives of The UK, WO329, Piece:2537, ancestry.co.uk: UK, World War I Service Medal and Award Rolls, 1914-1920 accessed 12 Mar 2025
26. British Army Medal and Award Record for William Jas Gilroy, 1914-198. The National Archives of The UK, WO329, Piece:2969, findmypast.co.uk: Silver War Badge Roll 1914-1920 accessed 17 Jul 2014
27. British Army Service Record for William James Gilroy, 13 Nov 1906 - 1 Mar 1910. The National Archives of The UK, WO97, Box:4937, 51 findmypast.co.uk: Chelsea Pensioners British Army Service Records 1760-1913 accessed 5 Dec 2017
28. The London Gazette of 5 May 1914 announcement regarding William James Gilroy. The Gazette Official Public Record, Issue:28828; Page:3676, (thegazette.co.uk: Official Record, accessed 15 Mar 2016)
29. World War 1 War Diary for Royal Field Artillery, 125 Brigade, Feb 1916. The National Archives of The UK, WO95/2521/5, 4 (nationalarchives.gov.uk: First World War and Army of Occupation War Diaries accessed
30. World War 1 War Diary for Royal Field Artillery, 125 Brigade, Feb 1916. The National Archives of The UK, WO95/2521/5, Page 29 (nationalarchives.gov.uk: First World War and Army of Occupation War Diaries accessed
31. Civil Registration and Parish Records
32. Church of England Baptism Record for William James Gilroy, 14 Jun 1891., London Church of England Parish Registers Reference Number: P72/JSG/015; Page:183; Entry:1457, (ancestry.co.uk: London, England, Church of England Births and Baptisms, 1813-1923, accessed 27 Jun 2014)
33. FamilySearch England and Wales Death Registration Index for Alistair J Gilroy, 1953; (familysearch.org: England and Wales Birth Registration Index, 1837-2008 (https://https://familysearch.org/ark:/61903/1:1:QV7N-WQCT accessed 17 Aug 2016) Original Data: General Register Office, England and Wales, Year:1953; Quarter:Apr-May-Jun; District:Leicester; Volume:3A; Page:802
34. FamilySearch England and Wales Death Registration Index for Ann E Widdowson, 1947; (familysearch.org: England and Wales Birth Registration Index, 1837-2008 (https://https://familysearch.org/ark:/61903/1:1:QV7H-S5FH accessed 12 Mar 2016) Original Data: General Register Office, England and Wales, Year:1947; Quarter:Jan-Feb-Mar; District:Pancras; Volume:5D; Page:782
35. FamilySearch England and Wales Death Registration Index for Nicholas J N Gilroy, 1962; (familysearch.org: England and Wales Birth Registration Index, 1837-2008

SOURCES AND CREDITS

(<https://familysearch.org/ark:/61903/1:1:QV7R-T3ZH> accessed 17 Aug 2016) Original Data: General Register Office, England and Wales, Year:1962;Quarter:Jul-Aug-Sep;District:Leicester Central;Volume:3A;Page:771

36.FamilySearch England and Wales Death Registration Index for Phyllis M Gilroy, 1950; (familysearch.org: England and Wales Birth Registration Index, 1837-2008 (<https://familysearch.org/ark:/61903/1:1:QV7F-837G> accessed 17 Aug 2016) Original Data: General Register Office, England and Wales, Year:1950;Quarter:Oct-Nov-Dec;District:Ilford;Volume:5A;Page:316

37.FamilySearch England and Wales Death Registration Index for Stuart D Gilroy, 1959; (familysearch.org: England and Wales Birth Registration Index, 1837-2008 (<https://familysearch.org/ark:/61903/1:1:QV7F-837G> accessed 17 Aug 2016) Original Data: General Register Office, England and Wales, Year:1959;Quarter:Oct-Nov-Dec;District:Leicester Central;Volume:3A;Page:726

38.FamilySearch England and Wales Death Registration Index for William J Gilroy, 1955; (familysearch.org: England and Wales Birth Registration Index, 1837-2008 (<https://familysearch.org/ark:/61903/1:1:QV7F-837G> accessed 17 Aug 2016) Original Data: General Register Office, England and Wales, Year:1955;Quarter:Jul-Aug-Sep;District:Leicester;Volume:3A;Page:676

39.Statutory Birth Register Entry for Brian Inglis, 1948, GROS: 885/3 989 (Canongate and Portobello accessed 10 Nov 2016)

40.Statutory Birth Register Entry for Caroline Mathieson Gilroy, 21 Mar 1923, National Records of Scotland GROS: 685/20 0225 (St Andrew) accessed 16 SEP 2014)

41.Statutory Birth Register Entry for Catherine Blacklaw Whitelaw, 1 Nov 1930, National Records of Scotland GROS: 79 0680 (Falkirk) accessed 6 Mar 2015)

42.Statutory Birth Register Entry for Catherine Macleod, 1956, National Records of Scotland GROS: 685/3 735 (Canongate and Portobello) accessed 10 Nov 2016)

43.Statutory Birth Register Entry for David Gilroy, 1956, National Records of Scotland GROS: 685/6/41 (Newington) accessed 18 Dec 2025)

44.Statutory Birth Register Entry for John Gilroy, 8th August 1921, National Records of Scotland GROS: 697/71 (Penicuik) accessed 19 JAN 2015)

45.Statutory Birth Register Entry for John Whitelaw Gilroy, 1949, National Records of Scotland GROS: 685/3 147 accessed 26 Jan 2019)

46.Statutory Birth Register Entry for Margaret Powell Macleod, 1952, National Records of Scotland GROS: 685/3 1319 accessed 10 Nov 2016)

47.Statutory Birth Register Entry for Rosalyn Macleod, 1955, National Records of Scotland GROS: 685/3 31 (Canongate and Portobello) accessed 10 Nov 2016)

48.Statutory Birth Register Entry for Rosetta Hannah Gilroy, 13th September 1925, National Records of Scotland GROS: 685/02 (St Andrew) accessed 19 JAN 2015)

49.Statutory Birth Register Entry for Terence M Inglis, 1954, National Records of Scotland GROS: 685/3 1324 (Canongate and Portobello) accessed 10 Nov 2016)

50.Statutory Birth Register Entry for William Mathieson Inglis, 1945, National Records of Scotland GROS: 685/03 1240 accessed 22 Jul 2016)

51.Statutory Death Register Entry for Ina Mathieson Gilroy, 17 Mar 1937, National Records of Scotland GROS:685/05 (George Square) accessed 18 MAR 1937)

52.Statutory Marriage Register Entry for John Gilroy and Jane Inglis Geall Wilson, 29 Mar 1947, National Records of Scotland GROS:685/01 0189 (Haymarket) accessed 27 Feb 2014)

53.Statutory Marriage Register Entry for Ross MacLeod and Catherine Blacklaw Gilroy, 1952, National Records of Scotland GROS:685/04 0050 (St Giles) accessed 20 JAN 2015)

54.Statutory Marriage Register Entry for WJ Gilroy and IM Whitelaw, 21 Oct 1914, National Records of Scotland GROS:1914 685/02 (St Andrew) accessed 10 FEB 2015)

55.Statutory Register of Births Entry for William James Gilroy, 14th May 1891. General Register Office, England and Wales; gro.gov.uk: Births Year:1891;Quarter:;District:Bethnal Green;Volume:1C;Page:192 accessed 2 Jan 2009

56.Statutory Register of Births Entry for William James Gilroy, 7th August 1918. General Register Office, England and Wales; gro.gov.uk: Births Year:1918;Quarter:Jul-Aug-Sep;District:Sheffield;Volume:9c;Page:993 accessed 14 Feb 2016

57.Statutory Register of Deaths Entry for Alexander Blacklaw Gilroy, 13 Jul 1989. General Register Office, England and Wales; gro.gov.uk: Deaths Year:1989;Quarter:Jul-Aug-Sep;District:Bedford;Volume:9;Page:106 accessed 17 Aug 2016

SOURCES AND CREDITS

58. Statutory Register of Deaths Entry for Rosetta Amelia Winton, 1 Jan 1956. General Register Office, England and Wales; gro.gov.uk: Deaths Year:1956;Quarter:;District:Shoreditch;Volume:5D;Page:615 accessed 20 Feb 2016
59. Statutory Register of Deaths Entry for William Gilroy, 5 Feb 1918. General Register Office, England and Wales; gro.gov.uk: Deaths Year:1918;Quarter:;District:Islington;Volume:1C;Page:326 accessed 27 Jan 2016
60. Statutory Register of Deaths Entry for William James Gilroy, 6 Jul 1965. General Register Office, England and Wales; gro.gov.uk: Deaths Year:1965;Quarter:;District:Thanet;Volume:5F;Page:589 accessed SEP 1965
61. Statutory Register of Marriages for George Winton and Rosetta Amelia Harris, 25 May 1915. General Register Office, England and Wales; gro.gov.uk: Marriages Year:1915;Quarter:Apr-May-Jun;District:Shoreditch;Volume:1C;Page:277 accessed 20 Feb 2016
62. Statutory Register of Marriages for Leslie Widdowson and Rosetta Hannah Gilroy, 17 Sep 1945. General Register Office, England and Wales; gro.gov.uk: Marriages Year:1945;Quarter:Jul-Aug-Sep;District:St Pancras;Volume:1B;Page:240 accessed 19 Mar 2022
63. Statutory Register of Marriages for William Blacklaw Gilroy and Olive Walker, 17 Feb 1951. General Register Office, England and Wales; gro.gov.uk: Marriages Year:1951;Quarter:Jan-Feb_Mar;District:Leicester;Volume:3a;Page:2029 accessed 4 Mar 2026
64. Statutory Register of Marriages for William James Gilroy and Anne Mitchell, 8 Feb 1947. General Register Office, England and Wales; gro.gov.uk: Marriages Year:1947;Quarter:Jan-Feb_Mar;District:Pancras;Volume:5d;Page:1040 accessed 22 Mar 2017
65. Statutory Register of Marriages for William James Gilroy and Kathleen Florence Latus, 23 Aug 1941. General Register Office, England and Wales; gro.gov.uk: Marriages Year:1941;Quarter:Jul-Aug-Sep;District:Hull;Volume:9D;Page:572 accessed 4 Mar 2026
66. Statutory Register of Marriages for William James Gilroy and Mary Phyllis Houghton, 3 Dec 1949. General Register Office, England and Wales; gro.gov.uk: Marriages Year:1949;Quarter:Oct-Nov-Dec;District:Ilford;Volume:5A;Page:773 accessed 4 Mar 2026
67. Newspapers
68. The Falkirk Herald, 20 Jun 1931 article re William James Gilroy and William James Gilroy; (findmypast.co.uk: Newspapers, accessed 6 Mar 2016) Original Data The British Library: The Falkirk Herald, 20 Jun 1931
69. Yorkshire Telegraph & Star, 31 Jan 1919 article re William James Gilroy; (findmypast.co.uk: Newspapers, accessed 15 Mar 2017) Original Data The British Library: Yorkshire Telegraph & Star, 31 Jan 1919